

THE WHISTLEBLOWERS: Lee Graham

UFO Buff Alleges Gov't. 'Sting'

By Don Ecker

In Vol. 6 No. 5 of UFO Magazine, we began the story of Lee Graham, a lover of high-tech aircraft and a real "bulldog" when it comes to filing FOIA requests for declassified UFO-related information.

Graham's odyssey into the UFO riddle began over 20 years ago, when he first heard about General Curtis LeMay's refusal to allow Senator Barry Goldwater into the celebrated "Blue Room" at Wright Patterson Air Force Base, where it's been rumored for decades that UFO secrets are hidden. As Graham's fascination with these matters increased, so did his determination to obtain factual information from the U.S. Air Force.

SUMMER, 1987—As he innundated the Air Force with numerous FOIA requests on such things as the MJ-12 documents, the 11-page version of the Project Aquarius documents and the DSP-1 spy satellite, Graham apparently came to official notice at the Air Force Office of Special Investigations (AFOSI). At this time, he was also corresponding with John Andrews of Testor Corporation, a fellow aircraft buff.

Testor Corp. had previously released a new model aircraft, which they named the "F-19 Stealth." Ac-



LEE GRAHAM with unidentified companion.

later informed by an unnamed source that the proper Stealth designation wasn't F-19, but "F-117, codenamed Senior Trend." Knowing Graham's penchant for super aircraft, Andrews told him the proper code name for the Stealth Fighter.

Late that summer, Graham promptly filed a FOIA on the F-117, beginning a chain of events still

Graham retrieved his DIS file through FOIA. In it is a letter from Thomas Ewald, a DIS Deputy Director (Investigations) to Kenneth McLaughlin, Director of Personnel Investigations, which states that the file on Graham was reopened, and apparently Graham was being tracked by the AFOSI.

He also determined that Hennessey was in contact with Andrews, who in turn carried on correspondence with Ben Rich of the Lockheed Corporation. Rich, Andrews says, would forward all of his correspondence back to AFOSI. Lockheed, as a government contract firm, apparently has to keep close tabs on the sorts of data flowing back and forth between these men.

The Air Force responded to Graham's FOIA on the F-117 by claiming they had no information on an aircraft called "F-117." Graham says, "... the Air Force admits now that they have records, but refuse to admit they lied. They could have used Executive Order 12356, (which stipulates responding to such inquiries with the statement that they could "neither confirm nor deny" the information). But they chose to lie."

At this point, the government demonstrated a definite interest in Graham by sending some visitors to meet with him. "In the early part of September," he continues, "Raymond Bader [a security officer at AeroJet General, Graham's employer] contacted me and said a couple of people—government agents, I guess—wanted to talk with me. He asked if I had a problem with it, and I said no . . . I later asked to have [Aerojet] representation with me during the meeting."

Two men, purportedly an FBI agent and an Air Force official, showed up on Sept. 15, 1987. Graham describes the encounter in his own words:

"They asked my security supervisor to leave so our talks could be private," Graham recalls. "They were bonafide agents, so I didn't

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cording to Andrews, Testor officials garnered enough detailed information on the Stealth project, purportedly from open sources, to fuel a belief that they had gotten a jump on the Stealth concept by introducing this new model, prior to the real aircraft's official declassification.

Code name 'Senior Trend'

According to Andrews, he was

unresolved today.

Graham says his persistent and continual FOIA requests caused a paper deluge within the Air Force and the Defense Investigative Service (DIS). It later came to light that Colonel Barry Hennessey, a commanding officer at the AFOSI, Special Projects, was keeping a file of all of Graham's correspondence, for reasons which are still unclear.

think there was a problem with my security supervisor leaving. The FBI agent brought out a wallet with all kinds of I.D., and I asked if I could Xerox his I.D., but he refused. They told me that they simply had come to provide me with information that I had requested via my FOIA requests.

"They began by praising my attempt to get the MJ-12 document declassified. The second man was not FBI . . . I was led to believe he was AFOSI.

"Eventually they asked me that if they provided me with information, would I sign a document (a security agreement), since the information was classified? I indicated, 'no problem,' and signed the document, which stated that I had been shown information for which I did not have a need to know."

'F-117 Nighthawk'

The second man, identified by Graham's security manager simply as "Mickey," opened a briefcase, displaying the document inside it. "I read 'F-117, Nighthawk'" Graham recalls. "The meeting ended with my showing 'Mickey' a copy of the 'Snowbird' document [purported Air Force document describing a test-flight project for ET aircraft]," Graham says.

"My friend Ron Regehr had stamped the Snowbird document UNCLASSIFIED, and when I showed it to "Mickey" he pointed at the UNCLASSIFIED stamp and asked me, what did it say? I stated that it said 'declassified,' and he told me then I could do with it what I wanted."

The whole problem with the above became apparent when Graham informed his security supervisor at the time, T.K. MacKinney, that he had been shown classified information for which he "did not have a need-to-know." MacKinney (he has since gotten another position) was shown a copy of the security agreement Graham had signed.

According to Graham, MacKinney laughed and said these two "agents" had come to AeroJet threatening Graham's security clearance. He accused Graham of having gone "belly up"—of rolling over and giving in to the agents—and as a result had named John Andrews as the source of the "F-117 Senior Trend" designation.



DEPARTMENT of DEFENSE

DEFENSE INVESTIGATIVE SERVICE



GRAHAM LEE MARVIN
 FILE NO: M 551-44-0616 34/11/28 06
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Signature *McGraw*

SECURITY MATTER—Above, cover page of file on Graham. Below, some of the DIS' reasoning behind the investigation.



DEFENSE INVESTIGATIVE SERVICE

1800 HALF ST., S.W.
WASHINGTON, D.C. 20324-1700



OCT 5 1989

Reply to
Attn of: VO433

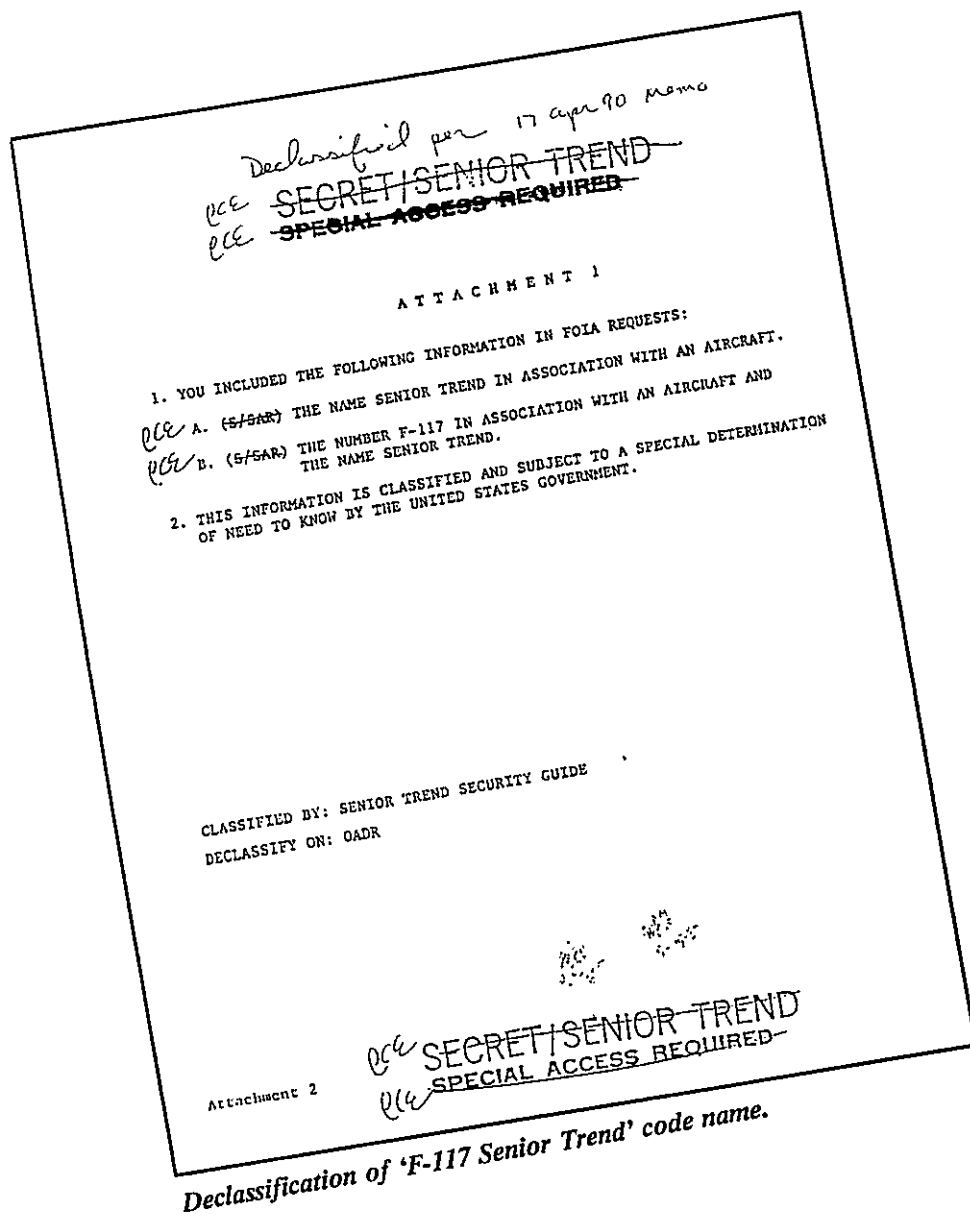
SUBJECT: Limited Inquiry, GRAHAM, Lee Marvin, SSN: 551-44-0616

TO: Mr. Thomas J. Rainsford
Director
Defense Industrial Security
Clearance Office

1. The attached information is forwarded for action. It is requested that an investigation be opened on Mr. Graham to determine his willingness to continue to safeguard classified information. It is further requested that a Special Agent and an Industrial Security Representative interview subject. Issues to be covered should include:
 - a. Mr. Graham's responsibility to protect classified information, or classified information he is currently having access to.
 - b. Is he aware that he is in violation of the non-disclosure agreement by pursuing this line of inquiry?

Further, he should be reminded that his requests are jeopardizing classified information outside his lines of inquiry. Specifically, he continues to use information he knows to be classified concerning the F117A in his letter to various government agencies and despite an explanation on the use of unclassified nicknames continues to use them in incorrect but sensitive association.

2. Mr. Graham is apparently a "UFO buff" and believes the government is involved in a conspiracy to cover up information about UFOs. In his attempts through FOIA requests to gain information about UFOs, Mr. Graham has made several disclosures inadvertent of information that is sensitive and classified. Because of this, Mr. Graham and



In essence, Graham interpreted MacKinney's charges to mean that the two agents had deliberately brought out the classified documents with the intention of placing Graham's position in jeopardy—a classic "Catch 22," he was in violation of security regulations whether or not he informed his supervisor of the events.

A call to AFOSI

Finally Graham called AFOSI. They stated that they did not give classified information to people, and claimed no knowledge of the events. Graham next called the FBI and spoke to Special Agent William J. Hurley, the agent who had visited Graham at AeroJet.

Sp. Agent Hurley informed Graham that he would not get in a



*Maj. Gen.
Michael C.
Kerby*

"pissing contest" with the Air Force.

Trying to track down "Mickey," the Air Force officer who had accompanied Sp. Agent Hurley, led to a surprise. Through C.B. Scott Jones, Ph.D., a 30-year Naval veteran who at one point had worked in Naval Intelligence, Graham was able to identify "Mickey" as Air Force Major General Michael C.

Kerby.

Jones, at that time a legislative assistant to Sen. Claiborne Pell (D-R.I.), had called Graham to advise him that they now had a "mutual acquaintance." Kerby had visited Jones at Pell's office.

Though Jones denies having discussed Graham or his ongoing battle with AFOSI with the Air Force officer, "Kerby knew of my interest in these matters," he says.

Coincidence?

On the exact same day of Graham's visit by the two agents, Andrews had been visited by Colonel John "Barry" Hennessey of AFOSI—the same Col. Hennessey who was keeping a record of Graham's FOIA request files!

Could Col. Hennessey have been Andrews' undisclosed source of the F-117 information? Could he have asked Andrews to leak the information to Graham?

Andrews denies this, but later told Graham he felt the events might be a "sting" operation because of the challenge Graham had presented by his continuous string of FOIA requests on the MJ-12 and Snowbird documents.

MacKinney supplied documentation to Graham stating that he (Graham) had been exposed to classified information, and as a result AFOSI was interested in him. Gen. Kerby was in fact Col. Hennessey's superior officer in the chain-of-command, and would have been advised by Hennessey of what was occurring.

Current known facts

The following facts are clear: On the date in question, September 15, 1987, a United States Air Force Colonel in charge of Special Projects for AFOSI was visiting John Andrews of Testor Corp. while Lee Graham received a visit at AeroJet from an FBI special agent and a United States Air Force General Officer.

The one thing that has ties them all together is Graham's FOIA requests, originally proposed by Andrews. The upshot is the DIS commencing another investigation of Graham, while Andrews states that he himself was never questioned about his knowledge of the F-117.

Graham launched another cam-

paign of FOIA requests to see if he could make heads or tails out of this confusing series of events. The Air Force denies that General Kerby had ever visited Graham; even though later Cecil Fry, the chief of AFOSI's Information Release, would admit to Graham that he was aware of all these events.

Graham sent Col. Hennessey FOIA requests, which by law should have been answered within 10 days. At press time, Graham had still not received any response.

When Graham found out about the file the AFOSI was keeping on him, he wrote to Senator Sam Nunn about this ordeal. Nunn's office made an inquiry to the AFOSI, which denied having any information on Graham.

NOTE: UFO has phone calls in to various players in this drama, including Col. Barry Hennessey and Dale Hartig, chief of the Office of Information and Public Affairs at the Defense Investigative Service. At press time, none of the calls had been returned.

C E R T I F I C A T E	
I, LEE M. GRAHAM	
EXPOSED TO INFORMATION WHICH HAS BEEN IDENTIFIED TO ME AS BEING CURRENTLY AND PROPERLY CLASSIFIED AND FOR WHICH I DO NOT HAVE A NEED TO KNOW. I FURTHER UNDERSTAND THAT I AM BOUND TO PROTECT THIS INFORMATION UNLESS INFORMED BY THE U.S. GOVERNMENT THAT IT IS NO LONGER CLASSIFIED. MY SIGNATURE BELOW AFFIRMS MY KNOWLEDGE OF MY INDIVIDUAL RESPONSIBILITIES TO PROTECT THE INFORMATION WHICH HAS BEEN IDENTIFIED TO ME AND WHICH IS LISTED IN ATTACHMENT 1 TO THIS CERTIFICATE. I WILL NEITHER DISCUSS NOR CONVEY, IN ANY MANNER, THE INFORMATION AND UNDERSTAND THAT DOING SO MAY SUBJECT ME TO CRIMINAL SANCTIONS AS SPECIFIED IN 18 UNITED STATES CODE SECTION 793, WHICH PROVIDES TERMS OF IMPRISONMENT NOT EXCEEDING 10 YEARS AND FINES NOT EXCEEDING \$10,000 FOR EACH OFFENSE. I UNDERSTAND THAT I MAY NOT DISCUSS THE INFORMATION OR THE EXISTENCE OF THE INFORMATION. I WILL REPORT IMMEDIATELY, TO THE NEAREST OFFICE OF THE FEDERAL BUREAU OF INVESTIGATION, ANY ATTEMPT, OR ACTION WHICH I BELIEVE TO BE AN ATTEMPT, BY UNAUTHORIZED PERSONS, TO SOLICIT OR OBTAIN THIS INFORMATION FROM ME. I UNDERSTAND THAT MY SIGNING THIS CERTIFICATE DOES NOT CONSTITUTE AN INDOCTRINATION FOR THE INFORMATION IN QUESTION. I EXECUTE THIS CERTIFICATE WITHOUT RESERVATION OR PURPOSE OF EVASION.	
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(SIGNATURE)	WITNESS:
(DATE)	(SIGNATURE)
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WITHOUT A 'NEED-TO-KNOW'—A copy of the agreement Graham was asked to sign, which documented his exposure to classified information, allegedly endangering his security clearance.

One Researcher's Opinion Were The Feds Out To Catch A Spy?

As UFO was completing the research for this article, a prominent West Coast UFO researcher, who requests anonymity, stated that he has information that may point to why this all transpired. Quite familiar with Graham and his story, the researcher suggests that the entire scenario may have been set up to catch a Soviet spy.

The source refuses to say where or from whom he received the information that he thinks backs up this suggestion. He feels that during the sequence of events referred to above, the AFOSI and the FBI had reason to believe that one of the other AeroJet employees, who like Graham holds a security clearance and has an interest in UFOs, may have been suspected of working for Soviet intelligence.

Aware that Graham speaks to co-workers about his interests, counterintelligence agents may have developed a plan to give informa-

tion specifically to Graham, banking on that information eventually reaching the suspect and whetting his or her appetite.

Graham, who has undergone two investigations, was not under any type of suspicion. But according to the researcher's belief, Graham would have been used as a conduit in a counterintelligence operation to expose the suspected Soviet agent.

There is no way to determine if this view has any validity, because neither AeroJet nor the Air Force are talking.

The UFO connection

Of course we keep coming back to the UFO connection. Graham's problems started with his inquiries on MJ-12, Aquarius and other UFO-related material. So far, he has been able to keep his security clearance after several attempts to revoke it.

Perhaps an indirect message to Graham is coming through. He received a letter from the Air Force rebuking him for being a "nuisance" and tying up taxpayer dollars with his FOIA requests.

It should also be noted that the Freedom of Information Act simply does not make information as free to citizens as might be assumed. Since the Reagan Administration, the federal government has drastically curtailed access via the FOIA.

An example is NASA's recent attempt to persuade Congress to hold the space agency exempt from FOIA, claiming the Japanese were legally "stealing" shuttle secrets by using the FOIA process. It turned out the Japanese spy excuse was a fabrication, that NASA was merely attempting to conceal embarrassing information about the Challenger tragedy. —D.E.